

A New Way of Living

God's purpose is to conform you to the image of Christ (Romans 8:29). This lifelong process is the work of the Holy Spirit as you give Him control moment by moment. There is tremendous freedom in giving control over to Him. You will no longer be imprisoned by self-centered cravings and passions.

The diagrams below illustrate two ways a Christian can live. In one, self remains on the throne. In the other, Christ is given His rightful place. The difference is not in whether a person has received Christ, but in who is allowed to direct daily life.



Self-Directed

Christ-Directed

The motivation for yielding control is not duty or pressure. It is the love of Christ. “Christ’s love controls us... He died for all so that those who live would no longer live for themselves” (2 Corinthians 5:14-15, NASB).

Todd's Story

“For three years I wanted nothing more than to join the most popular group at my high school—the Mavericks. Even after becoming a Christian, I still thought it might be harmless, even though it was a drinking club.

I finally decided I needed to go all out for Christ. That same week I was invited to join the Mavericks. I immediately knew that the stakes were high, and that Satan was trying to derail my decision. Instead of giving in, I turned my life fully over to God. He gave me freedom I had not known before and a purpose that reached beyond myself.”

A Simple Step of Surrender

Giving control of your life to the Holy Spirit is a decision of faith, just as receiving Christ was a decision of faith. You simply place yourself in the hands of a trustworthy God.

You might pray:

“Lord Jesus, I want my life to be directed by You rather than by self. I confess the ways I have lived independently of You. Holy Spirit, I ask You to take control of my life right now.”

Q: What does this kind of commitment mean to you?

Restoring Fellowship

At times, believers sin and break fellowship with the Holy Spirit (1 John 1:8). This does not mean your salvation is lost. Jesus paid for all your sins on the cross, once and for all. Broken fellowship means that you are not abiding in Christ. If it is not mended, you will not experience the abundant life Jesus promised and will begin to miss His purpose and plan for your life.

You can return and restore your fellowship with God at any moment. The way back is simple:

1. Yield yourself again to God.
2. Confess your specific sins
3. Trust the Spirit that He is in control.



Yield yourself
to God

Confess your
sins

Trust God to be
in control